

SYNTHETIC — illustrative, not from any real company. Written for a portfolio RAG project; does not describe any real retailer's internal procedure.

Stock Take SOP

SOP ID: SOP-STOCK-005 | Effective: February 1, 2026

Periodic full-store inventory count procedure, performed quarterly. This document covers preparation, count execution, and discrepancy resolution. The count table on the following pages must be completed section by section, in the printed order, since counting out of order has historically produced double-counted or skipped fixtures.

Preparation (Day Before Count)

Print count sheets for every fixture zone from the POS system, confirm the zone map matches the current floor layout (floor resets between quarters sometimes leave the zone map stale), and stage handheld scanners charged and zone-assigned the night before, not the morning of, since a scanner assignment error discovered mid-count is far more disruptive than one caught the night before with time to correct it.

Count Table — Zones 1 through 6

Zone	Fixture	Counted by	System qty	Physical qty	Variance
1	Endcap A	_____	___	___	___
1	Endcap B	_____	___	___	___
2	Wall unit A	_____	___	___	___
2	Wall unit B	_____	___	___	___
3	Table display A	_____	___	___	___
3	Table display B	_____	___	___	___
4	Clearance rack	_____	___	___	___
5	Fitting room hold	_____	___	___	___
6	Stockroom shelf A1-A12	_____	___	___	___

Count Table — Zones 7 through 12 (continued)

7	Stockroom shelf B1-B12	_____	___	___	___
8	Backstock overflow cage	_____	___	___	___
9	Register-adjacent impulse rack	_____	___	___	___
10	Seasonal display	_____	___	___	___
11	Return-to-vendor holding	_____	___	___	___
12	Damaged/write-off holding	_____	___	___	___

Discrepancy Resolution

A variance under 2% of a zone's system quantity is logged but requires no further action — normal shrinkage/counting-error range. A variance of 2–5% requires a recount of that zone alone before the count is finalized. A variance over 5% requires the store manager to review the zone's recent transaction log for the same window covered by Cash Handling SOP (SOP-CASH-009) discrepancy thresholds, since a large inventory variance and a cash variance in the same period often share a root cause — most commonly a miscoded return or an unlogged damage write-off, rather than actual loss.

Sign-Off

The completed count sheets from both pages above, along with any recount results from Section "Discrepancy Resolution," must be signed by the store manager and submitted to regional inventory control within 48 hours of count completion. Zones with an open variance investigation (over 5%) are submitted with a status of "pending" rather than "final" until the investigation closes, even if that means missing the 48-hour window for those specific zones — an incomplete but accurate submission is preferred over a complete but unverified one.